



Jarin Blaschke talks cinematography

The cinematographer of the *Lighthouse*, talks about how the film's haunting look was achieved. <https://digit.in/may20-39>



Picking the right lenses

In this interview, Jarin Blaschke talks about the lenses used in the *Lighthouse* and more. <https://digit.in/may20-40>

LENSES

To go along with the Panaflex Millennium XL 2 camera and the old black and white filmstock, Blaschke wanted to go with some rare vintage lenses. The lenses that were used to film were the Bausch & Lomb Baltar, Petzval lenses and a Pathe-Goerz Triplet lens.

PATHE-GOERZ TRIPLET LENS

According to an interview by No Film School, Blaschke visited Panavision and asked them what rare lens they had which no one knew about. They brought out one lens about the size of a thimble - an early triplet lens. According to IndieWire, it was the 50mm Pathe-Goerz Triplet lens.

BAUSCH & LOMB ORIGINAL BALTARS SET

In the same interview, Bauschke revealed that the people over at Panavision then brought out a set of lenses called Baltars. Not to be confused with Super Baltars, these original classic Baltars were used in filmmaking in Hollywood for years. From films like *Citizen Kane*, all the way through to films like *The Godfather* were all shot using the classic Baltars. Blaschke took a liking to the Baltars. According to him, the Baltars had a shimmery quality which made the highlights glow and was one of the most stunning portrait lenses he had ever seen.

PETZVAL LENSES

Going back to 1840, a Petzval lens is characterised by its swirly bokeh and sharp central focus. The lens swirls backgrounds that are out of focus in a distinctive way. This lens was only used for heightened moments and flashback sequences in the movie. In the interview with Musicbed, Blaschke revealed that Panavision had to painstakingly optically adjust the 35mm, 58mm and 85mm Petzval lenses in order to work with a modern film camera.

LIGHTING

In the interview with Musicbed, Blaschke revealed that the crew had to use a lot of light since the black and

white filmstock that he was using had low sensitivity to light at 80 ASA. It was blindingly bright. He also stated that he felt bad for the actors as they kept seeing spots and were barely even able to see each other during the shoot.

According to the Hurlbut Academy, for night scenes like the heightened dinner scenes, the lanterns were lit with an 800-watt halogen bulb which would flicker and were only a few feet from the actor's face. Closeups were



further amplified, with a China Ball. For daytime scenes, the ARRI M-series 9K and 18K HMIs were bounced through giant panoramas of muslin cloth outside the windows.

Moonlight exteriors were created by perching two Arrimax 18K lights on a 125 feet crane 500 feet across the bay. "With a fully extended arm we could swing over the ocean and get right down to the waves without submerging the camera.", said Robert Pattinson. These shots had to be scheduled with respect to the tides.

ASPECT RATIO

In the Musicbed interview, Blaschke said that the 1.19:1 aspect ratio meant that the sets would be confined. The actors had to be scrunched into the frame by putting the heads of the actors low in frame with a lot of headspace above in order to feel the ceiling. Since

the lighthouse was a vertical object Blaschke felt it was an intriguing task, since one only rarely gets to work with the vertical aspects in a movie. The sets had to be built in a way that would accommodate the boxy aspect ratio. The smaller aspect ratio also meant that movement was restricted. Most of the rehearsals that took place were to understand the geography and limit the movement.

THE IRISHMAN

Director: Martin Scorsese

Cinematographer: Rodrigo Prieto

Visual Effects Supervisor: Pablo Helman

Visual Effects Studio: Industrial Light & Magic (ILM)

Directed by Martin Scorsese, *The Irishman*, follows the story of a World War II veteran Frank Sheeran (Robert De Niro) recounting his life story, working as a hitman for mobster Russell Bufalino (Joe Pesci) and his time working for a Teamster, Jimmy Hoffa (Al Pacino).

In the Directors Roundtable from *The Hollywood Reporter*, Scorsese mentioned that Robert De Niro actually went up to him with the book and while describing the character became extremely passionate and emotional about the story. This made Scorsese fixate on the project.

The cast had already been decided. The downside, however, was the fact that there was no financing for it. Scorsese, De Niro, Pacino and Pesci all went their separate ways doing their films. Years later, when the time came around, the cast was way too old to play the roles. This was a major setback since the film was supposed to go back and forth in time continuously from the year 1949 to 2000 showing the different eras in the protagonists' life and career. Pablo Helman of Industrial Light & Magic (a VFX and Animation studio) reached out to Scorsese with the idea of using de-ageing in order to fix the issue. Scorsese was hesitant about the idea since that would mean the use of tracking marks all over the actors' faces which could affect their performance by hindering their facial expres-